

Security Breach Notification

[Date]

[Customer First Name] [Customer Last Name]

[Address 1]

[Address2]

[City, State, Zip]

Notice of Security Breach

Dear Customer,

The City of Eau Claire, Wisconsin is writing to inform you of a recent security incident involving one of our information systems. Protecting the privacy and security of your personal information is very important to us, and we want you to understand what happened, what information was involved, and what you can do.

What Happened?

On [date of discovery], our information Technology (IT) Department identified suspicious activity in a Microsoft SQL Server database used by the City of Eau Claire. An investigation determined that an unauthorized third party exploited a security vulnerability in Microsoft SQL Server 2016 (version 13.0, released June 1, 2016). This vulnerability allowed the attacker to gain access to the database.

As soon as we became aware of the issue, our IT team locked down the database, removed it from public access, and began working with Microsoft and security specialists to prevent any further unauthorized activity.

What Information Was Involved?

The affected database contained the following types of information:

- First and last name.
- Social Security number.
- Credit card information associated with payments made to the City.

Not every record contained all of this information, but based on our review, we believe that your Social Security number and other personal details may have been involved.

What we are doing.

To address this incident and reduce the risk of similar events in the future, the City has:

- Locked down and isolated the affected database.
- Upgrade all internal systems to the latest supported versions and applied all available security patches.
- Implemented additional monitoring, logging, and access controls.
- Reviewed our policies and procedures for handling and storing sensitive data.

Where appropriate, we have also notified law enforcement and are cooperating with any ongoing investigations.

What you can do.

We recommend that you take the following steps to help protect your information:

- Review your bank, credit card, and other financial account for any unauthorized activity and report suspicious charges immediately.
- Consider placing a fraud alert or security freeze your credit file with the major bureaus.
- Obtain and review a free copy of your credit report and monitor it for unfamiliar accounts or inquiries.
- Be cautious of unsolicited emails, phone calls, or messages asking for personal information, especially if they reference this incident.

Your right to request deletion of your data.

In certain circumstances and subject to legal record-retention requirements, you may request that we delete personal information that we no longer need to provide services or meet our legal obligations. If you wish to submit a Right to Delete Data request, or if you have any questions or concerns about this notice or our privacy and security practices, please contact us using the information below.

Contact Information.

Email: Helpdesk@eauclairewi.gov

Phone: (715) 839-3891

Mail: City of Eau Claire – Information Technology Department

[Street Address]

Eau Claire, WI [Zip Code]

We deeply regret that this incident occurred and any concern or inconvenience it may cause you. We are committed to protecting your information and strengthening our systems to help prevent this from happening again.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]

[Your Title]

City of Eau Claire – Information Technology Department